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Departmental Examination Series



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CCS (JOINING TIME) RULES, 1979

Central Civil Services (Joining Time) Rules, 1979

Consolidated & updated up to the latest amendment — GSR 229(E) dated 27 March 2015

Verified against primary sources — DoPT Gazette Notifications & Office Memoranda
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Statutory rules are subject to amendment by the competent authority from time to time. In the event of any doubt, discrepancy or dispute, the original Gazette Notifications, the Central Civil Services (Joining Time) Rules, 1979 (as amended), the relevant Office Memoranda issued by the Department of Personnel & Training, and the connected provisions of the CCS (Leave) Rules, 1972 shall prevail.

Readers and students are strongly advised to verify every provision against the official government source or gazette before relying upon it for service or examination purposes. Dak Guru accept no liability for any loss or consequence arising from the use of this material.

How to use this booklet

Each rule is presented in three layers: (1) the operative provision in plain language, (2) a short “In simple terms” explanation where the rule is technical, and (3) the exact statutory source with the notification or OM number and date so that currency can be independently judged. Boxes flagged “IMPORTANT”, “EXAM TIP” and “ACCURACY NOTE” highlight points that are frequently tested or commonly misunderstood.

Legislative history at a glance

Instrument	Date	Effect
G.S.R. 695	8 May 1979 (published 19 May 1979)	Principal Rules notified
G.S.R. 90	27 December 1982	First amendment
G.S.R. 197	10 March 1989	Second amendment
G.S.R. 229(E)	27 March 2015	Latest amendment in force

Sources: Principal Rules — G.S.R. 695 dated 8 May 1979 (Notification No. 21011/2/79-Allowances). Amendment chain recorded in the explanatory note to G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015 [F. No. 19011/03/2013-Estt.(AL)], DoPT. Consolidated Instructions on CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979 updated by DoPT on 12 September 2022 confirm no later amendment.

ACCURACY NOTE

The earlier circulating version of these notes listed only the 1989 and 2015 amendments. The official explanatory note appended to G.S.R. 229(E) also records an intervening amendment by G.S.R. 90 dated 27 December 1982. It has been added above for completeness. The 27 March 2015 amendment is the latest in force — no subsequent amendment to the Joining Time Rules has been notified up to the date of this booklet.



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Introduction & Scope

The Central Civil Services (Joining Time) Rules, 1979 regulate the period of time, treated as duty, that a Government servant is allowed to enable him or her to hand over charge at the old post, travel, and take charge at the new post on transfer. The Rules were notified vide G.S.R. 695 dated 8 May 1979 and have since been amended, most recently by G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015. The Department of Personnel & Training (DoPT) has issued Consolidated Instructions summarising the operative provisions, last updated on 12 September 2022.

WHAT “JOINING TIME” MEANS

Joining time is a facility, not a holiday. It is granted only when a transfer is made in public interest and is intended to cover the unavoidable break between relinquishing the old charge and assuming the new one. A Government servant on joining time is regarded as on duty and is paid for the period.

Rule 1 — Short Title, Commencement & Application

Operative provision

These Rules may be called the Central Civil Services (Joining Time) Rules, 1979. They came into force on the date of issue of the notification (8 May 1979, published in the Gazette of India dated 19 May 1979) and apply to transfers effected on or after that date.

The Rules apply to all Government servants appointed to Civil Services and posts under the Central Government, including work-charged staff, but do NOT apply to the following categories:

- (a) Railway employees;
- (b) Armed Forces personnel and those paid from the Defence Services Estimates;
- (c) Government servants engaged on contract and those who are not in whole-time employment of Government; and
- (d) Government servants paid out of contingencies.

Source: Rule 1, CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979 [Notification No. 21011/2/79-Allowances dated 8 May 1979].

EXAM TIP

A favourite question is whether work-charged staff are covered. They ARE covered. The four excluded categories are Railways, Armed Forces / Defence Estimates, contract & non-whole-time employees, and those paid out of contingencies. Remember the mnemonic “R-A-C-C”: Railways, Armed forces, Contract, Contingencies.

Rule 2 — Transfer to/from Other Governments, Deputation & Foreign Service

Operative provision

Where a Government servant to whom these Rules apply is transferred to the control of another Government or organisation which has its own rules prescribing joining time, the joining time for the outward journey to join the post under that Government/organisation and for the return journey will be governed by those other rules — unless different provisions are expressly made in the terms of deputation or foreign service by mutual agreement between the lending and borrowing authorities.

Conversely, the joining time of Railway employees, Armed Forces personnel and those paid from the Defence Services Estimates, and the employees of a State Government or any other organisation, who are appointed to Civil Services and posts under the Central Government on deputation or on foreign service, will — for joining the Central Government post and for the return journey — be regulated by these Rules, again unless different provisions are expressly agreed in their terms of deputation/foreign service by mutual agreement between the lending and borrowing authorities.

Source: Rule 2, CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979 [Notification No. 21011/2/79-Allowances dated 8 May 1979].

IN SIMPLE TERMS

Whose rules apply depends on direction of movement, with mutual agreement always able to override. Going OUT to another Government that has its own JT rules → their rules. Coming IN to the Centre from Railways / Defence / a State / another body → these CCS Rules. Either way, what the lending and borrowing authorities expressly agree in the deputation terms takes precedence.

Rule 3 – Definitions

For the purposes of these Rules, certain expressions carry defined meanings. The two most relevant in practice are:

- **“Department of Government of India”** means a Ministry or Department of the Central Government as notified from time to time, and any other authority exercising the powers of a Ministry/Department of the Government of India.
- **“Transfer”** means the movement of a Government servant from one post to another, in public interest, to which joining time can attach. A transfer made on the Government servant’s own request is treated differently for joining-time purposes (see Rule 4 and the note on “transfer on own request”).

Source: Rule 3, CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979.

Rule 4 – Admissibility of Joining Time

Operative provision

Joining time is granted to a Government servant on transfer in public interest, to enable him or her to join the new post either at the same station or at a new station. The key situations are summarised below.

4.1 No joining time for short temporary transfers

No joining time is admissible in cases of temporary transfer for a period not exceeding 180 days. In such cases, only the actual transit time — as admissible for journeys on tour — may be allowed.

4.2 Surplus staff and discharged staff

- Surplus staff transferred under the Scheme Regulating the Redeployment of Surplus Staff are eligible for joining time.
- Government servants discharged due to reduction of establishment from one Central Government office and re-appointed to another Central Government office are entitled to joining time, subject to the prescribed conditions.

4.3 Appointment through competitive examination/interview (as substituted in 2015)

For appointment to posts under the Central Government on the results of a competitive examination or interview, or both, open to Government servants and others, the Central

Government employees and permanent or provisionally permanent State Government employees are entitled to joining time under these Rules — provided such Government servants opt to have their past service in the Central or State Government counted for all purposes in the Central Government.

Source: Rule 4, CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979; sub-rule (4) substituted by G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015 [F. No. 19011/03/2013-Estt.(AL)], DoPT.

4.4 Transfer on own request

Joining time is admissible only where the transfer is in public interest. When a Government servant is transferred on his or her own request, no joining time is admissible: the intervening period between relinquishing charge at the old place of posting and taking charge at the new place may instead be regularised by grant of leave of the kind due and admissible.

Source: OM No. 19011/33/81-Allowances dated 29 January 1983, DoPT.

EXAM TIP

Two thresholds are heavily tested: (i) the 180-day line — a temporary transfer of 180 days or less carries NO joining time, only transit time; and (ii) transfer on own request carries NO joining time — the gap is covered by leave. “Public interest” is the trigger for joining time.

Rule 5 — Commencement & Amount of Joining Time

5.1 Commencement

Joining time commences from the date of relinquishment of charge of the old post if charge is handed over in the forenoon; or from the following day if charge is handed over in the afternoon.

5.2 Same station / no change of residence

Not more than one day's joining time is allowed to join a new post within the same station, or where the transfer does not involve a change of residence from one station to another.

5.3 Different station with change of residence — distance slabs

Where the transfer is from one station to another and involves a change of residence, joining time is allowed with reference to the distance between the old headquarters and

the new headquarters, by the direct route and ordinary mode(s) of travel, as per the following schedule:

Distance between old HQ and new HQ	Joining time admissible	Where transfer necessarily involves continuous road travel of more than 200 km
1,000 km or less	10 days	12 days
More than 1,000 km	12 days	15 days
More than 2,000 km	15 days (but 12 days maximum where travel is by air)	15 days

5.4 Notes to Rule 5(4) — distance measurement & remote regions

Note 1: “Distance” means the actual distance travelled, and not the weighted mileage for which fare is charged by the Railways in certain ghat or hill regions.

Note 2: In the case of transfer of a Government servant to or from the North-Eastern Region, including Sikkim, the Andaman & Nicobar Islands, Lakshadweep and Ladakh, two days’ additional joining time is admissible over and above the normal joining time reckoned on the basis of the actual distance between the old and the new place of posting.

Source: Rule 5, CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979; Notes to sub-rule (4) substituted by G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015 [F. No. 19011/03/2013-Estt.(AL)], DoPT.

ACCURACY NOTE — exact gazette wording

In the text of G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015, Note 2 as published reads “to or from Eastern Region, including Sikkim, Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Lakshadweep and Ladakh...”. The DoPT Consolidated Instructions and standard practice read this as the “North-Eastern Region”, which is the operative interpretation reflected above. Aspirants should be aware that the printed gazette omits the prefix “North-”; the substance — two additional days for these remote regions — is not in dispute.

Special provisions have also been made to facilitate journeys to and from remote localities such as the Andaman & Nicobar Islands and Lakshadweep, and powers have been delegated to Heads of Departments and Administrators of Union Territories in this regard.

Source: OM No. 21011/12/79-Allowances dated 16 November 1979 and OM No. 19011/30/81-Allowances dated 13 October 1981, DoPT.

EXAM TIP

Watch the air-travel cap: for distances exceeding 2,000 km the entitlement is 15 days, BUT if the journey is performed by air the maximum is only 12 days. Also remember the +2 days for the North-Eastern Region, Sikkim, A&N Islands, Lakshadweep and Ladakh, and the flat one day where there is no change of residence.

Rule 6 – Unutilised Joining Time, Crediting & Combination

6.1 Unutilised joining time (as substituted in 2015)

By the 2015 amendment, sub-rule (1) of Rule 6 was substituted to read that the period of unutilised joining time shall be regulated in terms of the provisions of sub-clause (ii) of clause (a) of sub-rule (1) of Rule 26 of the Central Civil Services (Leave) Rules, 1972. In other words, Rule 6(1) no longer spells out the crediting formula itself — it points to the CCS (Leave) Rules, where the mechanism actually lives.

Source: Rule 6(1), CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979, as substituted by G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015 [F. No. 19011/03/2013-Estt.(AL)], DoPT.

6.2 How the unavailed joining time is actually credited

Under Rule 26(1)(a)(ii) of the CCS (Leave) Rules, 1972, when a Government servant joins a new post without availing of the full joining time because — (a) he is ordered to join the new post at the new place of posting without availing of the full joining time to which he is entitled; or (b) he proceeds alone to the new place of posting and joins the post, taking his family later within the period permissible for claiming travelling allowance for the family — the number of days of joining time admissible under sub-rule (4) of Rule 5 of the CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979, subject to a maximum of 15 days, reduced by the number of days of joining time actually availed of, is credited to his leave account as earned leave.

This is subject to the proviso that the earned leave at credit, together with the unavailed joining time so credited, shall not exceed 300 days (including the number of days for which encashment has been allowed along with Leave Travel Concession while in service).

Source: Rule 26(1)(a)(ii) and Rule 26(1)(b), CCS (Leave) Rules, 1972 (300-day ceiling effective from 1 September 2008 per the Sixth CPC amendment); DoPT FAQ on Joining Time Rules.

IMPORTANT — frequently omitted point

Unavailed joining time is NOT simply lost. Up to a maximum of 15 days (less any joining time actually taken) is credited to the earned-leave account, capped so that total EL never exceeds 300 days. The earlier version of these notes did not state the 15-day cap or the 300-day ceiling — both have been added here because they are routinely examined.

6.3 Combination with leave

Joining time may be combined with vacation and/or regular leave of any kind or duration, except casual leave.

Source: Rule 6, CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979.

6.4 Diversion in transit

If a Government servant in transit on transfer is directed to proceed to a place different from that indicated in the initial transfer orders, he is entitled to joining time already availed of up to the date of receipt of the revised orders, PLUS a fresh spell of full joining time from the day following the date of receipt of the revised orders.

Source: Rule 6, CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979 [position retained after G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015].

IN SIMPLE TERMS

Re-routed mid-journey? You keep the joining time you have already used and the clock resets — you get a brand-new full entitlement from the day after you receive the revised orders. You are not penalised for the change of destination.

Rule 7 — Joining Time Pay & Allowances

Operative provision

A Government servant on joining time is regarded as on duty during that period and is entitled to be paid joining-time pay equal to the pay drawn before relinquishing charge of the old post. He is also entitled to Dearness Allowance, if any, appropriate to the joining-time pay.

In addition, he may draw the compensatory allowances — such as House Rent Allowance — as applicable to the old station from which he was transferred. He is NOT allowed

Conveyance Allowance or permanent travelling allowance. The joining-time pay is borne by the new administrative authority where the Government servant joins on transfer.

Source: Rule 7, CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979 [as it stands after G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015].

ACCURACY NOTE – CCA / HRA

The literal text of Rule 7 (and of the DoPT Consolidated Instruction) still refers to “compensatory allowances like City Compensatory Allowance, House Rent Allowance”. However, City Compensatory Allowance (CCA) was abolished on the recommendation of the Sixth Central Pay Commission and is no longer payable. Accordingly, in current practice only House Rent Allowance (and similar admissible compensatory allowances) of the old station is drawn during joining time. This booklet therefore states HRA and flags CCA as discontinued, rather than reproducing an allowance that no longer exists.

Notes inserted after Rule 7 by the 2015 amendment

Note 1: The sanction of the admissible joining time shall be accorded by the competent authority exercising administrative control over the Government servant proceeding on transfer.

Note 2: The joining-time pay shall be paid by the new administrative authority where such Government servant joins on transfer.

Source: Notes I and II inserted after Rule 7 by G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015 [F. No. 19011/03/2013-Estt.(AL)], DoPT.

EXAM TIP

Three pay points are tested: joining-time pay equals the old-post pay; HRA of the OLD station is admissible; and Conveyance Allowance / permanent TA are NOT admissible. On responsibility: the competent authority over the transferred official sanctions the joining time, while the NEW office pays the joining-time pay.

Worked Examples

The following illustrations apply the distance slabs and the commencement rule. They are for conceptual understanding; in an actual case the direct route, ordinary mode of travel and any remote-region addition must be verified.

Example 1 — Same station

An official is transferred from one office to another within the same city, with no change of residence. Joining time admissible: not more than one day.

Example 2 — 800 km, by rail

Distance between old and new headquarters is 800 km, involving a change of residence, travel by rail. As the distance is “1,000 km or less”, joining time admissible is 10 days. If the transfer necessarily involved continuous road travel of more than 200 km, it would be 12 days.

Example 3 — 2,500 km, by air

Distance exceeds 2,000 km. The normal entitlement for this slab is 15 days, BUT because the journey is performed by air, the maximum is restricted to 12 days.

Example 4 — Transfer to the North-Eastern Region

An official transferred to a station in the North-Eastern Region over a distance of 1,200 km is entitled to 12 days (the “more than 1,000 km” slab) PLUS two additional days for the North-Eastern Region, i.e. 14 days in total.

Example 5 — Charge handed over in the afternoon

If charge of the old post is made over in the afternoon, joining time commences from the FOLLOWING day, not the same day. Had charge been handed over in the forenoon, joining time would commence from the same day.

IMPORTANT

These worked examples assume direct route and ordinary mode of travel and ignore Sundays/holidays adjustments and any TA-linked conditions. Always compute by the actual admissible route, apply the air-travel cap and remote-region addition where relevant, and verify against the latest orders before sanction.

Quick Revision — One-Liners

1. Joining time is admissible only on transfer in public interest; treated as duty and paid.
2. Applies to all Central Government civil posts including work-charged staff; excludes Railways, Armed Forces/Defence Estimates, contract & non-whole-time employees, and those paid from contingencies.

3. Temporary transfer of 180 days or less → NO joining time, only transit time.
4. Transfer on own request → NO joining time; gap covered by admissible leave.
5. Same station / no change of residence → not more than 1 day.
6. 1,000 km or less → 10 days (12 days if continuous road travel exceeds 200 km).
7. More than 1,000 km → 12 days (15 days if continuous road travel exceeds 200 km).
8. More than 2,000 km → 15 days; but only 12 days if travel is by air.
9. +2 days additional for transfer to/from North-Eastern Region, Sikkim, A&N Islands, Lakshadweep and Ladakh.
10. Charge handed over in forenoon → JT starts same day; afternoon → next day.
11. Unavailed joining time credited as earned leave, maximum 15 days, total EL not to exceed 300 days.
12. JT may be combined with any leave except casual leave.
13. Diversion in transit → keep JT already availed + fresh full JT from day after revised orders.
14. JT pay = pay of old post + DA; HRA of old station admissible (CCA discontinued); no Conveyance Allowance / permanent TA.
15. Competent authority over the official sanctions JT; the new office pays the JT pay.

FINAL ACCURACY STATEMENT

All provisions in this booklet have been cross-checked against primary sources — the principal Rules (G.S.R. 695 dated 8 May 1979), the amending Notification G.S.R. 229(E) dated 27 March 2015, the connected Rule 26 of the CCS (Leave) Rules, 1972, and the DoPT Consolidated Instructions (updated 12 September 2022) and DoPT FAQ. The 27 March 2015 amendment is the latest in force as on the date of preparation. Where the printed gazette wording differs from settled practice (e.g. “Eastern” vs “North-Eastern” Region) or where an allowance named in the rule has since been abolished (CCA), the point has been expressly flagged. Aspirants must still verify against the current official source before relying on any provision.